

Cacti

The animals in this biome are limited in number. They are able to bear the drought and the heat of the desert. Animals like the camel, antelopes, fox, spotted hyena, fallow deer, cape hare, hedgehog etc., live in the desert.

The tropical desert biomes are agriculturally unproductive except in and near the oasis. In the oasis, cultivation is carried through irrigation either from streams or from underground sources. Date palms are widely grown here.



Oasis in Sahara

The people in the deserts are generally nomads living in tents and moving from place to place. They are the Berbers of North Africa, the Bedouins of the Arabian deserts, the Damara in Namibia, the Bushman of the Kalahari Desert and the Aborigines of Australia. They practice food gathering and hunting while some herd cattle, goats and camel and some of them practice very simple subsistence farming.



One of the toughest foot races in the world is held in Sahara every year in April. This race is called The Marathon des Sables (MDS) and participants have to cover a distance of 250km over Sahara desert in southern Morocco in a span of 7 days. About 1500 participants aged between 16 to 79 from all over the world participate in this race.

Source : Morocco World News

vii. Taiga or Boreal Forest Biome

The taiga biome is the largest terrestrial biome and extends across Europe, North America and Asia. The taiga biome is also known as coniferous forest or boreal forest biome. It extends from about 50° to 70° North latitudes. This region lies between the temperate grassland in the south and the polar tundra in the north. The taiga region is absent in the southern hemisphere mainly because of the narrowing of continents towards the South Pole.

This biome has short wet summer and long cold winters. The taiga region has low mean annual precipitation ranging between 35 cm to 60 cm and the rainfall occurs mostly in summer. It receives plenty of snow during winter.

The taiga or boreal forest biome consists mainly of evergreen coniferous forests. The important coniferous trees in this biome are pines, spruces, firs, maples and cedars. During the short summer season snow melts and this helps lichens,

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